

- being able to totally customise your site
- themes will be continually updated
- technical support availability
- more advanced and technical functionalities
- could be used for large websites of corporations and online news magazines.

(To learn more about WordPress, check out <http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/WordPress>).

The search for *that* perfect theme

Two months: Yes, we took two months to finally get the look that LinuxForU.com finally has, today. Hours of using Google's servers' processing time yielded a lot of results but we found none of them satisfactory. We considered quite a few WP theme developers like WooThemes (woothemes.com), wphacks (wphacks.com), PremiumWP (premiumwp.com), NattyWP (nattywp.com), WordPressThemesMarket (wordpressthemesmarket.com) and Premium Themes (premiumthemes.net) and finally managed to zero down to just four themes that suited our purpose. They were:

1. Open Book, from WPHacks (lyxia.org/blog)
2. The Stars, from Premium WP (premiumwp.com/demo/thestars)
3. Guzel Magazine, from Deluxe Themes (newwpthemes.net/guzel-magazine-2)
4. Comfy magazine, from Deluxe Themes (deluxethemes.com/comfy)

Our first choice was the OpenBook theme because we liked the overall look that was simple yet elegant. Moreover, we were keen on a dark background for the site, and black is the sexiest you

can find. OpenBook had fit into our requirements pretty well since we were looking for top menu-driven navigability that also has drop-downs, and easily-recognised categorisation of the content. As for the sidebar, despite being scant, it never lacked

functionality. So, although I had always preferred a four-column template, with fluid width and two sidebars, I could not find myself saying, "No" to OpenBook. Thus LinuxForU.com's development began based on OpenBook.

A few days of digging into the code and customising it, and we managed to stumble upon "The Stars" theme from Premium WP. We immediately fell in love with the design, owing to its vibrant look and colourful pictures (we admit, we got seduced by the beautiful ladies featured in the theme :-)). Suddenly, all our theme customisation got scrapped and we embraced "The Stars". We were aware that we HAD TO get rid of the shocking pink from the theme's colour scheme, and come up with a colour combination of our own. It was tough, but it was a challenge I was ready for.

I was always in love with the dark menu bar that "The Stars" had. I made conscious efforts not to change that and yet work on revamping the theme's colour scheme. Hundreds of colour choices later, we finally decided on the pleasant blue and orange combo that LinuxForU.com currently features. A few more days and the complete colour scheme of the site got changed to blue, with a dash of orange. There was also a lot of customisation that had been done in the individual pages (more about that later) and the prospects were looking good.

Fortunately or unfortunately, fate always had a way of getting us distracted to better and more beautiful beings, and Atanu Datta (another member of LFY bureau) managed to chance upon two more theme designs



LinuxForU.com—the final look

that we simply couldn't ignore. They were 'Guzel' and 'Comfy' from Deluxe Themes. The reason we fell in love with both of those themes was the way they featured stories (neater, easier to understand and more user friendly), the prominence with which the subscription widget was placed, and a search bar that was easy to find and understand. While the search bar on "The Stars" was funkier, it was much more prominent on the other themes.

These distractions posed a huge problem, especially for me, because the current theme had already been extremely customised and it would have been a pain in the you-know-where to again deploy another theme and start working on it. We had already spent a whole month in our quest for that ideal look for the website. On the other hand, it was also tough for us to ignore the advantages provided by 'Guzel' and 'Comfy'.

Even between 'Guzel' and 'Comfy', we failed to decide on one of them because while we loved the curvy looks of 'Comfy', 'Guzel' looked more complete and professional. Functionality-wise, 'Guzel' lagged a bit because it features only one story on the home page, for every category, as opposed to the five in the case of 'Comfy'. This made me ask myself a question, "What is it about 'Guzel' and 'Comfy' that's attracting us? Can we implement the same in the existing theme of LinuxForU.com?" It was this thought process that did the trick for us. I finally started segregating the content boxes giving them a distinct look, to make them look a little elevated



The Stars theme—from where the LinuxForU.com's look has been derived